

● HARD

● EXPRESSION OF IDEAS

● ANSWER KEY

Rhetorical Synthesis

02

10 answers · Rationale-rich · Teach from doc

ANSWER KEY · SAT QUESTION BANK

2026-05-29

Q1**D**

- D. Nissologists' different definitions can result in huge disparities in counts of islands, as the example of Sweden shows.
-

Choice D is the best answer. The sentence makes a generalization about nissologists' definition of an island—specifically, that the use of one definition rather than another can result in huge disparities in the number of islands counted—and supports that generalization by citing Sweden as an example.

Choice A is incorrect. The sentence introduces one definition of an island to an audience unfamiliar with nissologists; it doesn't make a generalization about nissologists' definition of an island. Choice B is incorrect. While the sentence synthesizes information from the notes about counts of Sweden's islands, it doesn't make and support a generalization about nissologists' definition of an island. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence makes an inference about islands in Sweden; it doesn't mention nissologists' definition of an island or make a generalization about it.

Q2

B

- B. Evidence that Khoesan and Basotho peoples may have found an *M. carinatus* phalanx as long ago as 1100 CE suggests that Plot may not have been the first person to have discovered dinosaur remains.
-

Choice B is the best answer. Noting that the evidence suggests Indigenous peoples may have found dinosaur remains in 1100 CE, the sentence emphasizes how the 1990 discovery challenged Plot's reputation as the first person to discover dinosaur remains.

Choice A is incorrect. While the sentence does emphasize that Benoit challenged Plot's reputation, it misrepresents information in the notes; Plot was reputed to be the first person to discover dinosaur remains in general, not the first person to discover *M. carinatus* remains specifically. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence only partially explains the significance of the 1990 discovery, noting that it suggests Indigenous people brought dinosaur remains to the cave in 1100 CE; it doesn't explain the discovery's significance to Plot's reputation. Choice D is incorrect. While the sentence does emphasize that the discovery challenged Plot's reputation, it misrepresents information in the notes. The notes don't indicate that the 1990 discovery cast any doubt on Plot's claims to have found fossilized dinosaur bones; rather, the discovery challenged Plot's reputation for being the first to discover dinosaur bones.

Q3

A

- A. In considering some but not all cognitive systems modular, Fodorian modularity is not as expansive in its definition of modularity as MMH is.
-

Choice A is the best answer. The sentence compares Fodor's hypothesis with Carruthers's, noting that because Fodorian modularity considers some but not all cognitive systems modular, it is not as expansive in its definition of modularity as Carruthers's MMH, which includes all cognitive systems.

Choice B is incorrect. The sentence describes Carruthers's hypothesis—that modularity of mind includes all cognitive systems—but indicates only that this hypothesis followed Fodor's 1983 hypothesis rather than making a comparison between the hypotheses. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence misrepresents a difference between Fodor's and Carruthers's hypotheses. According to the information in the notes, both Fodor and Carruthers consider low-level cognitive systems modular, and their difference lies in whether they also consider high-level systems modular. Choice D is incorrect. The sentence misrepresents a difference between Fodor's and Carruthers's hypotheses. According to the information in the notes, both Fodor and Carruthers consider the mind to be at least partly composed of innate neural structures (modules). Their difference lies in whether they consider high-level systems modular.

Q4

D

- D. According to Padmanabhan and Chen, the brain can toggle between capturing olfactory information at a given moment and tracking changes in that information over time.
-

Choice D is the best answer. The sentence effectively summarizes the study's findings, explaining what Padmanabhan and Chen found: that the brain can toggle between one method of processing smells (capturing information at a given moment) and another (tracking changes in information over time).

Choice A is incorrect. While the sentence mentions findings, it mainly focuses on Padmanabhan and Chen's methodology. It doesn't effectively summarize the study's findings. Choice B is incorrect. The sentence notes a fact about the olfactory system—that the perception of odor forms in the piriform cortex—but doesn't summarize the findings of Padmanabhan and Chen's study. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence presents the goal of Padmanabhan and Chen's study; it doesn't summarize the study's findings.

Q5

C

- C. Locke-Rodriguez and colleagues found that FTWs using marigolds not only helped remove phosphorus from the water but also yielded market-quality blooms.
-

Choice C is the best answer. The sentence presents both findings from the study, noting that FTWs using marigolds both removed phosphorus from the water and yielded market-quality blooms.

Choice A is incorrect. While the sentence presents a finding from the study, the presentation is incomplete; the study found that marigolds cultivated on FTWs both removed phosphorus from the water and yielded market-quality blooms. Choice B is incorrect. The sentence misrepresents information in the notes. The figure of 52% refers to the amount of phosphorus removed by FTWs using marigolds when compared to the control; the marigolds' bloom yield was 65 market-quality blooms per square meter, and it was not compared to the control. Choice D is incorrect. The sentence misrepresents information in the notes. The FTWs using marigolds removed 52% more phosphorus from the water than did the control, not 52% of the total phosphorus. Additionally, the bloom figure is incomplete; the figure is 65 market-quality flower blooms per square meter.

Q6

A

- A. Researchers wanted to know which factors influence lizard egg clutch size because such factors have been well studied in birds but not in lizards.
-

Choice A is the best answer. The sentence emphasizes the aim of the research study by highlighting what the researchers conducting the study wanted to know—specifically, which factors influence clutch size among lizards.

Choice B is incorrect because the sentence emphasizes what researchers determined at the end of the study, not what the study's aim was. Choice C is incorrect because the sentence emphasizes a finding from the research study, not the aim of the study. Choice D is incorrect because the sentence emphasizes the research study's methodology, not its aim.

Q7

C

- C. Humans may have first arrived in the Americas by sea, traveling between Pacific Ocean islands and coastlines and subsisting on a variety of resources.
-

Choice C is the best answer. This choice summarizes the main idea of the kelp highway hypothesis, providing a high-level overview of how the hypothesis explains human migration to the Americas.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice describes one aspect of the proposed scenario but doesn't discuss human migration, which is the main focus of the kelp highway hypothesis. Choice B is incorrect. This choice introduces the kelp highway hypothesis but doesn't explain what it entails. Choice D is incorrect. This choice describes one element of the proposed scenario but doesn't discuss human migration, which is the main focus of the kelp highway hypothesis.

Q8

C

- C. Even though Hanoi (population 7,781,631) is larger than Ulaanbaatar (population 907,802), Ulaanbaatar accounts for more of its country's population.
-

Choice C is the best answer. The sentence emphasizes the relative sizes of the capital cities' populations, noting that even though Hanoi has more people overall, Ulaanbaatar accounts for a larger percentage of the people in its country.

Choice A is incorrect. While the sentence indicates the population size of each capital, it fails to emphasize their sizes relative to each other or to their countries' overall population sizes. Choice B is incorrect. The sentence emphasizes the population sizes of the two countries; it fails to mention the capitals. Choice D is incorrect. While the sentence indicates the population size of each capital, it fails to emphasize their sizes relative to each other or to their countries' overall population sizes.

Q9

D

- D. The Alta conflict had a lasting impact, resulting in international attention and legal protections for Sámi rights to lands, waters, and resources.
-

Choice D is the best answer. It makes a generalization—the conflict had a lasting impact—and then supports it with evidence—the attention and protections were results of the conflict.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice doesn't make a generalization about the conflict. It describes a specific event from the conflict. Choice B is incorrect. This choice makes a generalization about the Alta conflict, but doesn't support it. Choice C is incorrect. This choice makes a statement about the aftermath of the conflict, but doesn't support it. The statement is also a little too specific to be a generalization.

Q10

A

- A. *Sonic Meditations* is not music but rather a series of sound-based meditations that consist of instructions; Meditation XVIII, for instance, instructs participants to “listen to a sound until you no longer recognize it.”
-

Choice A is the best answer. It describes what a “Sonic Meditation” is, and then gives an example in the form of Meditation XVIII.

Choice B is incorrect. This choice describes what a “Sonic Meditation” is, but doesn't give an example of one. Choice C is incorrect. This choice gives an example of a “Sonic Meditation,” but doesn't explain what the meditations are. Choice D is incorrect. This choice doesn't describe what a “Sonic Meditation” is.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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